



IT Patch Management

MAY 2023
Version 1.0

1.1 Purpose

This document outlines the necessary steps for keeping all Massar Solutions-managed IT systems and software current. Massar Solutions is committed to ensuring the confidentiality, integrity, and accessibility of all data stored on its systems. This includes third-party systems and services that Massar Solutions manage. Massar Solutions is responsible for providing adequate protection for all its IT resources. By following this policy, the risk of system compromise due to known vulnerabilities is minimized.

1.2 Scope

- All IT systems owned by Massar Solutions and managed by the IT department.
- All IT systems used by Massar Solutions but managed by third parties.

1.3 Roles and Responsibilities

The IT Manager is accountable for ensuring that the software is updated and the patching policy is adhered to.

IT Systems Engineers and Senior IT Systems Engineers ensures that all in-scope software they manage is maintained through regular updates and patching.

1.4 Definitions

IT Systems refers to:

- Physical Servers
- Virtual Servers
- Third Party Managed Servers.
- End user compute devices (laptops/desktops etc.)
- Server Operating Systems (both Microsoft and non-Microsoft)
- Server Applications – (i.e.: Microsoft IIS or SQL etc.)
- Applications – (i.e.: Productivity Tools such as MS Office, Adobe Reader, and Web Browsers etc.)
- Network Devices

1.5 Software updates and patching

To ensure proper functionality, all Massar Solutions-owned IT systems (as defined in section 1.4) and those being developed and supported by third parties must have appropriate licensing, manufacturer support, and up-to-date operating systems and application software.

In order to safeguard Massar's IT systems against known vulnerabilities, it's essential to deploy security patches within an appropriate timeframe. To do so, patches should be installed according to the following schedule.

1.5.1 Public Facing Servers

Vulnerability classification	Full deployment within (calendar days)
Exploitable	7
Critical	14
High	21
Medium	28
Low	28

1.5.1.1 If Massar cannot deploy security patches that are prone to exploitation within 7 days, they must implement compensating controls or a temporary mitigation to minimize the risk to their IT systems.

1.5.2 Non-Public Facing Servers

Vulnerability classification	Full deployment within (calendar days)
Exploitable	14
Critical	21
High	28
Medium	35
Low	35

1.5.2.1 If Massar cannot deploy security patches that are prone to exploitation within 14 days, they must implement compensating controls or a temporary mitigation to minimize the risk to their IT systems.

1.5.3 Laptops & Desktops

Vulnerability classification	Full deployment within (calendar days)
Critical	14
High	21
Medium	35
Low	35

1.5.3.1 If Massar cannot deploy security patches that are prone to exploitation within 7 days, they must implement compensating controls or a temporary mitigation to minimize the risk to their IT systems.

1.5.4 Network Devices.

Vulnerability classification	Full deployment within (calendar days)
Exploitable	7
Critical	14
High	21
Medium	35
Low	35

1.5.4.1 If Massar cannot deploy security patches that are prone to exploitation within 7 days, they must implement compensating controls or a temporary mitigation to minimize the risk to their IT systems.

1.5.4.2 New systems must be patched to the current agreed baseline before coming online in order to limit the introduction of new threats.

1.5.4.3 To meet the standards set by the Massar Solutions IT department, servers must adhere to the recommended minimum requirements. These requirements include the default operating system level, service packs, hotfixes, and patching levels. The IT department will document any exceptions to these standards.

1.5.4.4 Every month, Microsoft releases its security patches on the second Tuesday, also known as "Patch Tuesday." The patches are then deployed as per the patch schedule.

1.5.4.5 Before patching, it's important to have a remediation plan in place that will restore the system to a functional state. This can involve either rolling back to a previously known good state or fixing the issue by removing patches and restoring backups.

1.5.4.6 If you have the responsibility of patching as outlined in section 1.3, it is mandatory that you create and manage reports that summarize the results of each patching cycle. These reports will help evaluate the current patching status of all systems and determine the current level of risk.

Document Signoff		
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